

August 12, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Sammie Zemlak (MRN MUSC3070109), Claim MUSC-20260427-7D92-1

Patient	Sammie Zemlak (DOB 1959-01-28)
MRN	MUSC3070109
Member ID / Group	BCB250343600 / GRP-96407
Claim number	MUSC-20260427-7D92-1
Date of service	2026-04-27
Procedure billed	CPT 99223 — Initial hospital care, high complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$4,828.83
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-08-28

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of patient Sammie Zemlak (MRN: MUSC3070109, Member ID: BCB250343600, Group: GRP-96407) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260427-7D92-1 for services rendered on April 27, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied on May 30, 2026, under CARC 16 ("Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s)") and RARC N290 ("Missing/incomplete/invalid rendering provider primary identifier"), with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid." The total billed amount of \$4,828.83 remains unpaid. We respectfully assert that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier was valid at the time of submission and request immediate reprocessing of this claim.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Zemlak is a 67-year-old male with an established and complex medical history, including active chronic congestive heart failure, anemia, prediabetes, and longstanding hypertension. He was admitted as an inpatient (Place of Service 21) on April 27, 2026, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis of anemia, unspecified (D64.9). Given his active comorbidities — particularly chronic congestive heart failure managed with furosemide injection, oral Lasix, and extended-release metoprolol succinate — an acute upper respiratory illness in this patient population warrants close inpatient monitoring and high-complexity medical decision-making. Rendering provider Robert K. Lindqvist, MD, performed the initial hospital care evaluation, billed under CPT 99223 (Initial hospital care, high complexity), which is consistent with the clinical complexity presented by this patient's active conditions and medication regimen.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier — the National Provider Identifier — was missing, incomplete, or invalid on the submitted claim. MUSC Health asserts that Dr. Robert K. Lindqvist's NPI, 1314059687, was included on the original claim submission dated May 9, 2026, and is an active, valid NPI registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPES). This NPI uniquely and correctly identifies Dr. Lindqvist as the rendering provider for the April 27, 2026 encounter.

To the extent that a technical or formatting discrepancy caused the NPI to appear absent or unreadable during adjudication, such an error does not reflect a substantive deficiency in the claim and does not alter the medical necessity or appropriateness of the services rendered. Payers are generally obligated under applicable claims processing standards to request missing or clarifying information before issuing an outright denial when the provider of record is otherwise identifiable. The corrected claim or supporting documentation provided with this appeal confirms the valid NPI and resolves the identified deficiency in full.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina reopen and reprocess Claim MUSC-20260427-7D92-1 using the confirmed rendering provider NPI 1314059687 for Dr. Robert K. Lindqvist, and issue payment at the allowed amount of \$3,212.91 in accordance with the terms of the BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus plan. This appeal is submitted within the appeal deadline of August 28, 2026, through the My Insurance Manager portal as directed, with the remittance advice and supporting documentation attached. Should additional information be required to complete adjudication, we ask that MUSC Health be contacted promptly so that any outstanding items may be resolved without further delay.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record